The Feasts of the Lord Fulfilled in Christ

The seven appointed times of Leviticus 23 and what they reveal about the Messiah's first and second comings.



Twelve charts · Leviticus 23 · Colossians 2:16–17 · thegospelvault.com

A shadow of what is to come

Introduction · Leviticus 23:2 · Colossians 2:16–17

"…things which are a mere shadow of what is to come; but the substance belongs to Christ." — Colossians 2:17

mo'adim

"appointed times" · Lev 23:2

Not Israel's feasts — "My appointed times." Fixed meetings God Himself set on the calendar, laid out in one chapter in the order of the farming year.

Stated by the NT writers

- Passover 1 Cor 5:7
- First Fruits 1 Cor 15:20
- Pentecost Acts 2:1
- Day of Atonement Hebrews 9
- Tabernacles John 7:37–39

Drawn from the pattern

Much of the prophetic meaning of the fall feasts — inferences from the overall pattern and the Old Testament prophets. The study is honest about the difference.

Two questions for each feast: What did it mean to Israel? How does the New Testament say it is fulfilled in Jesus the Messiah?

God's prophetic calendar

Leviticus 23 · spring, the long summer, and fall

SPRING · 1st month				SUMMER	FALL · 7th month		
Passover 14th Lamb slain	**Unleavened Bread** 15th–21st Sinless body	**First Fruits** day after sabbath Risen Lord	**Pentecost** +50 days Spirit poured out	**No feast** ~4 months of harvest Gleaners in the field (23:22)	**Trumpets** 1st Gathering call	**Day of Atonement** 10th Nation cleansed	**Tabernacles** 15th–21st + 8th day God dwells with His people

FULFILLED — first coming | **NOW — the present age** | **ANTICIPATED — second coming**

The spring feasts are finished; the summer harvest is underway; the fall feasts are still waiting on the calendar.

I. Passover — the Lamb slain

Spring · 1st month, 14th day · Leviticus 23:4–5 · Exodus 12

THE SHADOW · what Israel kept

Each household killed an unblemished male lamb a year old (Ex 12:5) and put its blood on the doorposts and lintel.

"When I see the blood I will pass over you" (Ex 12:13).

"Nor are you to break any bone of it" (Ex 12:46) — kept for centuries without knowing why.

THE SUBSTANCE · fulfilled in Christ

"Behold, the Lamb of God" (John 1:29); crucified at Passover (John 19:14).

Not a bone broken — "so that the Scripture would be fulfilled" (John 19:36).

"Christ our Passover also has been sacrificed" (1 Cor 5:7); redeemed by precious blood (1 Pet 1:19).

God's promise was not "when I see your worthiness," but "when I see the blood." Security rests on the Lamb, received by faith.

II. Unleavened Bread — the sinless body

Spring · 1st month, 15th–21st · Leviticus 23:6–8 · 1 Corinthians 5:6–8

THE SHADOW · what Israel kept

Seven days; every trace of leaven removed from the house (Ex 12:15).

Recalled the haste of the Exodus — dough with no time to rise (Ex 12:34, 39).

Leaven pictures what quietly corrupts and spreads: *"a little leaven leavens the whole lump"* (1 Cor 5:6; Gal 5:9).

THE SUBSTANCE · fulfilled in Christ

He "knew no sin" (2 Cor 5:21); tempted "yet without sin" (Heb 4:15).

Buried as the feast began; His body lay in the tomb during it.

"Nor … allow Your Holy One to undergo decay" (Ps 16:10; Acts 2:27, 31).

Position before practice: "you are in fact unleavened" (5:7) — so "clean out the old leaven." The holy walk flows from redemption; it never purchases it.

III. First Fruits — the risen Lord

Spring · "the day after the sabbath" · Leviticus 23:9–14 · 1 Corinthians 15:20–23

Friday · 14th of the month	**Saturday** · 15th of the month	**Sunday** · 16th of the month
Passover **Christ crucified**	Unleavened Bread · sabbath **Body in the tomb**	First Fruits **Christ raised**

Pharisees read "sabbath" as the feast rest day (→ 16th); Sadducees as the weekly Sabbath (→ Sunday). With a Friday-14th crucifixion, the two readings meet.

The shadow
The first sheaf was waved before the Lord — a token and a pledge that the rest of the harvest would follow (Lev 23:10–11).

The substance
"Christ has been raised from the dead, the first fruits of those who are asleep" (1 Cor 15:20).

"Christ the first fruits, after that those who are Christ's at His coming" (1 Cor 15:23). Because the first sheaf was accepted, the harvest is certain.

IV. Pentecost — the Spirit poured out

Spring · fifty days after First Fruits · Leviticus 23:15–22 · Acts 2

First Fruits → seven full weeks + 1 = 50 days → **Shavuot · Pentecost ("fiftieth")**

The Law given · Sinai	The Spirit given · Acts 2
~3,000 died Exodus 32:28	**~3,000 given life** Acts 2:41

"The letter kills, but the Spirit gives life." — 2 Corinthians 3:6

The first sheaf was one resurrected Man; the Pentecost harvest was a body of people — the church, born by the Spirit's baptizing work (1 Cor 12:13).

Two loaves "baked with leaven"

Lev 23:17 — the only feast where leaven is commanded

Lamb and sheaf picture Christ, without sin; the loaves picture His people, who are not — likely Jew and Gentile made "one new man" (Eph 2:14–16), accepted with the sacrifices.

"When the day of Pentecost had come … suddenly there came from heaven a noise like a violent rushing wind." — Acts 2:1–2

The long summer — the present age

Between the feasts · Leviticus 23:22 · Romans 11:25

The one verse placed in the gap

"You shall not reap to the very corners of your field nor gather the gleaning of your harvest; you are to leave them for the needy and the alien." — Leviticus 23:22

Israel's calendar	The church age	Israel's program
Goes quiet for about four months after Pentecost while the harvest is gathered in the fields.	The Spirit gathers a harvest from every nation — outsiders gleaning in Israel's field.	"A partial hardening has happened to Israel until the fullness of the Gentiles has come in" (Rom 11:25).

God's program for the church in this age is distinct from His unfinished program for the nation of Israel — and the feast calendar fits that distinction.

V. Trumpets — the gathering call

Fall · 7th month, 1st day · Leviticus 23:23–25 · Numbers 10:1–10

In Israel, trumpets summoned the congregation, moved the camp, and sounded the alarm for war — and called the nation to attention ten days before the Day of Atonement. (Later: Rosh Hashanah.)

For the church

"With the trumpet of God … the dead in Christ will rise first … caught up together … to meet the Lord in the air." (1 Thess 4:16–17)

"At the last trumpet" — 1 Cor 15:52

For Israel

A "great trumpet" regathers the scattered nation. (Isaiah 27:13; Matthew 24:31)

Interpreters differ on which gathering Trumpets pictures primarily — both are announced by a trumpet.

A caution

Don't date the rapture by Rosh Hashanah.

"Of that day and hour no one knows" (Matt 24:36); "it is not for you to know times or epochs" (Acts 1:7). The rapture is imminent — no sign or date must come first.

Trumpets tells us what is coming, not when. "Therefore comfort one another with these words." — 1 Thessalonians 4:18

VI. The Day of Atonement — the nation cleansed

Fall · 7th month, 10th day · Leviticus 16; 23:26–32 · Hebrews 9–10

	Israel's high priest	Christ, our High Priest
How often	Every year	Once for all (Heb 9:12)
Where	An earthly sanctuary, behind the veil	Heaven itself, "not made with hands" (9:11, 24)
With what blood	Goats and calves	His own blood (9:12)
Posture	Stands daily, offering again and again (10:11)	Sat down at the right hand of God (10:12)
Result	Sacrifices that can never take away sins	"Perfected for all time" — eternal redemption (10:14; 9:12)

Still to come: the nation

"They will look on Me whom they have pierced; and they will mourn for Him." — Zech 12:10

"And so all Israel will be saved." — Rom 11:26

The atonement was completed at the cross; what remains is for the nation to look upon Him and receive it.

A seated priest is a finished work. The redemption He obtained is "eternal" — not provisional, not renewable each year, not dependent on later performance.

VII. Tabernacles — God dwelling with His people

Fall · 7th month, 15th–21st + 8th day · Leviticus 23:33–43 · John 7–8

In the wilderness

- Seven days in booths of branches — "so that your generations may know that I had the sons of Israel live in booths" (Lev 23:42–43).
- The great harvest festival; God dwelling in their midst.

At His first coming

- "The Word became flesh, and dwelt (skēnoō, tabernacled) among us" (John 1:14).
- Water-drawing from Siloam → "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink" (John 7:37–38).
- Golden lampstands → "I am the Light of the world" (John 8:12).

In the kingdom

- The nations go up "to worship the King … and to celebrate the Feast of Booths" (Zech 14:16).
- "Behold, the tabernacle of God is among men, and He will dwell among them" (Rev 21:3).

The invitation He gave at Tabernacles has no qualifications attached: "if anyone is thirsty." The only condition is to come and drink — to believe in Him.

The seven feasts at a glance

Leviticus 23 · timing, fulfillment, and status

Feast	Lev 23	Timing	Fulfillment in Christ	Status
Passover (Pesach)	4–5	1st month, 14th	Christ our Passover sacrificed (1 Cor 5:7)	**Fulfilled — first coming**
Unleavened Bread	6–8	1st month, 15th–21st	The sinless One in the tomb; believers "unleavened" (1 Cor 5:7–8)	**Fulfilled — first coming**
First Fruits (Bikkurim)	9–14	Day after the sabbath	Christ raised, "the first fruits" (1 Cor 15:20)	**Fulfilled — first coming**
Pentecost (Shavuot)	15–22	50 days after First Fruits	The Spirit poured out; the church formed (Acts 2:1–4)	**Fulfilled — first coming**
Trumpets (Yom Teruah)	23–25	7th month, 1st	The trumpet of gathering (1 Thess 4:16; Matt 24:31)	**Anticipated — second coming**
Day of Atonement (Yom Kippur)	26–32	7th month, 10th	Finished once for all (Heb 9:12); Israel's repentance (Zech 12:10)	**Accomplished; national fruit anticipated**
Tabernacles (Sukkot)	33–43	7th month, 15th–21st + 8th day	The Word "dwelt" among us (John 1:14); nations keep it (Zech 14:16)	**Foreshadowed; anticipated — kingdom**

CONCLUSION · SHADOW AND SUBSTANCE

Leviticus 23 is the gospel in calendar form

A foundation that cannot move

The Lamb has been slain, the atonement is finished, the First Fruits has been raised, and the Spirit has been given as a seal.

A hope that cannot fail

The trumpet will sound, Israel will look on the One they pierced, and God will dwell with His people forever.

The calendar opens with Passover — with what God provides and the sinner receives. Eternal life is a gift, by faith alone in Christ alone; the unleavened walk, the Spirit's fruit, and the kingdom's reward follow from that gift and never secure it.

"If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink." — John 7:37